

13 March 2020

I am writing to describe the steps Ascent is taking in response to the Covid-19 pandemic.

We value our relationship with our customers, and we want our customers to know that our top priority is delivering superior products and excellent service to our customers. Accordingly, we are taking every precaution possible to protect the health and well-being of our team members, their families, and others in our communities.

On 27 February 2020, we implemented specific procedures recommended by the US Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC), World Health Organization (WHO), and federal, state, and local public health officials. These include proactive guidelines for limiting in-person meetings; practicing social distancing; sanitizing work areas frequently; and encouraging healthy behaviors such as frequent and thorough handwashing, use of alcohol-based hand sanitizers containing at least 60% alcohol, and sneezing and coughing in ways so as not to infect others. We discontinued domestic and foreign travel in favor of virtual meetings. We prohibited visitors, including delivery people, from entering our headquarters. In addition, we directed all members of our team to stay home if they did not feel well and not to return to work, in Ascent offices and in customer offices, until they were no longer sick.

We continue to monitor the situation closely, and we will implement all new procedures recommended by the US Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC), World Health Organization (WHO), and federal, state, and local public health officials as they become available.

We also directed all members of our Boston team to switch from working in their headquarters offices to working remotely from their homes as soon as practicable so we could join the effort to slow down the rapidly increasing rate of infection. I am pleased to say all members of the Boston sales, development, and support teams are now working remotely from home. Fortunately, Ascent implemented technologies that enable the entire Ascent team to work together productively and seamlessly, with full access to all our systems, from remote locations more than a decade ago. We are all well versed in the use of these technologies, so there should be no disruption in the services we provide. All our computing resources reside in the AWS cloud platform, and we do not depend on any one Ascent team member to keep our infrastructure operational. Our support team is comprised of highly qualified engineers with extensive cross-disciplinary experience; we will continue to serve our customers' needs in the event we need to operate with a reduced team. Our Boston headquarters is currently open and staffed by at least one person during regular business hours; however, this could change with little notice, in accordance with government recommendations, policies, and directives.

On behalf of the entire Ascent team, I thank you sincerely for your understanding and support during this difficult and rapidly changing situation.

Sincerely,

Karen A. Prendergast
President